

EAM310 · EAM DIAGNOSIS I · VUIM · SUMMER 2026

Worksheet

Active Recall · Multiple Choice · True-False · Clinical Cases + Key

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Week 3 · Pulse Diagnosis · Summer 2026

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TCM for Ballroom Dancers | Dance Medicine Specialty

How to use this

Cover the Workbook. Answer from memory. Then check against the Answer Key at the back — recognition is not recall.

A Active Recall

1. Name all six pulse positions with their Nan Jing organ pairings (L and R).

2. List the five finger movements and what each checks for.

3. What three qualities define a normal pulse? Give characters and meanings.

4. List all eight components of a normal pulse.

5. Name all four seasonal pulses with their date ranges.

6. Floating + Tight = ? Floating + Rapid = ? Floating + Empty = ?

7. Deep + Slow = ? Deep + Rapid = ? Deep + Weak = ?

8. Differentiate Knotted, Hasty, and Intermittent by speed and pause pattern.

9. Which of the 28 is generally a HEALTHY pulse, and what defines it?

10. Give the classical image for: Slippery, Choppy, Hollow, Leather, Scattered.

11. What are the four indications of a Slippery pulse?

12. How do you differentiate Exterior-floating from Yin-Deficiency-floating?

13. What does a Flooding pulse in winter signify, and why?

14. Whose breath is the pulse rate counted against, and what is the normal range?

15. Name the three Deficiency-side qualities on Schrier's comparison chart.

B Multiple Choice

1. The Nan Jing pairing for the LEFT Chǐ position is:

- A. Kidney-Yin only
- B. Foot Taiyang/BL · Foot Shaoyin/KD
- C. Hand Shaoyang/TB · Hand Jueyin/PC
- D. Foot Jueyin/LR

2. A pulse beating 4 times per breath, faster than Slow, generally indicates:

- A. Cold pattern
- B. Yang Deficiency
- C. A healthy pulse (Huǎn)
- D. Interior Heat

3. Which pulse is classically 'a pearl rolling on a plate'?

- A. Choppy
- B. Slippery
- C. Moving
- D. Soggy

4. Intermittent (代 Dài) differs from Knotted and Hasty because:

- A. It is faster
- B. Its pauses occur at regular intervals
- C. It is only felt at the deep level
- D. It indicates Blood stasis

5. A Flooding pulse felt in winter most likely indicates:

- A. Normal seasonal variation
- B. A warning sign of excess Yang
- C. Yang Deficiency
- D. Blood Deficiency

6. 'Scraping bamboo with a small knife' describes:

- A. Tight
- B. Wiry
- C. Choppy
- D. Firm

7. Floating + Empty may indicate Summer-Heat OR Yin Deficiency. The differentiator is:

- A. Rate
- B. Degree of floating
- C. Position
- D. Rhythm

8. Which indicates severe Kidney-Essence/Kidney-Yin deficiency?

- A. Hollow
- B. Leather
- C. Scattered
- D. Hidden

9. The Hidden pulse (伏 Fú) is felt only by:

- A. Light touch
- B. Moderate pressure
- C. Pressing very heavily to the bone
- D. Rolling

10. Wiry + Rapid indicates:

- A. Liver-Fire
- B. Cold in the Liver channel
- C. Blood Stasis
- D. Liver-Yang rising

11. Normal pulse rate per Schrier's slides is:

- A. 40–60 bpm
- B. 60–90 bpm
- C. 90–140 bpm
- D. 140–180 bpm

12. 'Flower blossoms lightly scattering to the ground' is:

- A. Soggy
- B. Minute
- C. Scattered
- D. Moving

C True / False

1. The pulse rate is traditionally counted against the patient's breath, not the practitioner's. TRUE / FALSE

2. A Slippery pulse can indicate pregnancy. TRUE / FALSE

3. Hasty is Slow with irregular stops. TRUE / FALSE

4. Huǎn (Slowed-Down/Moderate) is a pathological pulse. TRUE / FALSE

5. Floating always indicates an Exterior pattern. TRUE / FALSE

6. Deep + Wiry can indicate a Chong Mai issue. TRUE / FALSE

7. Leather and Hollow both feel hollow beneath the surface. TRUE / FALSE

8. The Chǐ position on the right pairs Kidney with Bladder per Nan Jing. TRUE / FALSE

D Clinical Cases

Case 1

A 34-year-old dancer presents 2 days after onset of chills and fever occurring together, with occipital stiffness, no sweating, and body aches. Pulse is Floating and Tight.

1.1 Name the pulse combination and its indication.

1.2 Which Eight Principles categories does this place her in?

1.3 What single finding would tell you the pathogen had moved Interior?

Case 2

A 58-year-old presents in January with a wide, forceful pulse that fades gently, plus irritability and thirst for cold drinks.

2.1 Name the pulse quality.

2.2 Is this seasonally appropriate? Explain.

2.3 What did Schrier's teaching case warn about this presentation?

Case 3

A patient's pulse is thin like a fine thread but distinct, with no rhythm interruption. She reports dizziness, poor memory, and scanty periods.

3.1 Name the pulse quality and its core indication.

3.2 Which combination would you check for to confirm Yin Deficiency with Empty-Heat?

3.3 Contrast this pulse with Minute/Faint.

E Answer Key

Section A — Active Recall

Answers are in Workbook §1–8. Self-check each against the corresponding reference table.

#	Answer
1	B
2	C
3	B
4	B
5	B
6	C
7	B
8	B
9	C
10	A
11	B
12	C

#	True/False — Answer
1	FALSE — the practitioner's.
2	TRUE
3	FALSE — Hasty is RAPID with irregular stops; Knotted is slow.
4	FALSE — generally healthy.
5	FALSE — also Yin Deficiency.
6	TRUE
7	TRUE
8	FALSE — right Chǐ = TB/PC; left Chǐ = BL/KD.

Case 1

Floating + Tight = **Exterior Wind-Cold**. Eight Principles: Exterior / Cold / Excess (Yang-category on the Exterior axis). The pathogen has moved Interior the moment the SIMULTANEOUS aversion-to-cold-and-fever disappears — and the Floating pulse should go with it.

Case 2

Overflowing / Flooding 洪. NOT seasonally appropriate — Flooding belongs to summer (May 5–Aug 6); this is January. Schrier's case: a patient with winter Flooding who declined treatment suffered a cerebral hemorrhage the following summer when seasonal Yang rise compounded already-excessive Yang.

Case 3

Fine/Thin 細 — Blood Deficiency. Check **Fine-Rapid** to confirm Yin Deficiency with Empty-Heat. Minute/Faint 微 is more extreme: extremely thin AND forceless, fading in and out, indicating severe Qi AND Blood depletion — Fine stays distinct and clear.